

WEEK-7

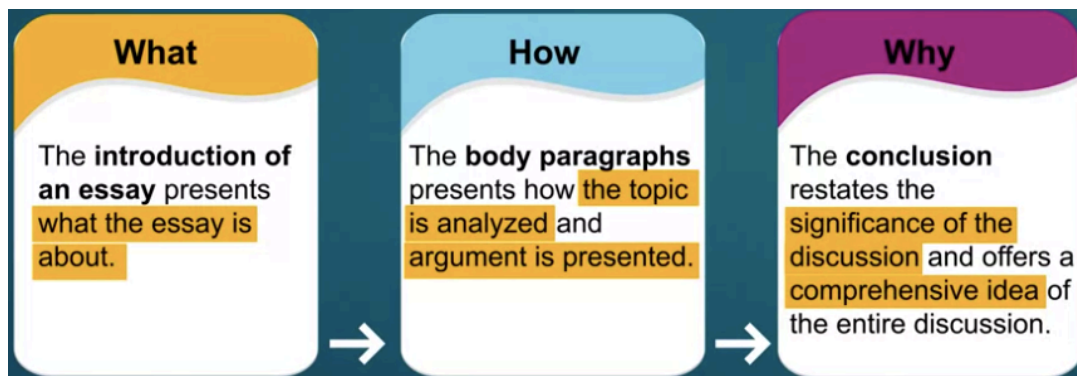
Introduction to Essay Writing

Video 1: Structure of an Essay

Structure of Academic Essays

- An academic essay consists of three parts
 - Introduction
 - Presents the topic and the thesis statement
 - Conveys information on the significance of the study
 - Presents the main argument of the essay
 - Explains the design of the discussion
 - Body paragraphs
 - Contain an analysis of the topic in an in-depth manner
 - Elaborately present the argument and supporting literature/evidence to support the argument
 - The discussion on the topic takes place in this section
 - Conclusion
 - Restates the main points
 - Summarizes the analysis
 - Presents an overall understanding of the topic

Mapping an Essay



Types of Academic Essays

- Academic essays can be broadly categorized into four types
 - Descriptive essays
 - Describe a person, place, object, experience, situation, and so on
 - Provide information about something
 - Analytical essays
 - Analyze a specific topic
 - Critically examine the given topic using supporting literature and examples
 - Persuasive (argumentative) essays
 - Present an argument
 - Persuade the readers to adopt a certain point of view

- Expository essays
 - Examine an idea and explain it
 - Present an argument comprehensibly

Video 2: Outline of an Essay

Purpose of an Essay Outline

- The first step to writing an essay
- A blueprint of an essay
- Used to brainstorm the main ideas and points to include in the essay
- Helps organize the ideas and points in an appropriate order
- The basis for creating sections and subsections of the essay
- Gives clarity to the writer

Strategies to Create an Outline

- Brainstorm ideas
 - If working as a team
- Research
 - Conduct and gather information
- Pick main points
 - Ideas to be included in the essay
- Sequence main points
 - In a logical sequence using numerical lists, such as roman numerals or alphabets
- Include sub-points
 - Related ideas under each main point using bulleted lists
- Review the outline
 - Remove unnecessary points, fill in missing information, or rearrange points to improve cohesion

Essay Outline Example

Essay Topic: Ethical Use of Artificial Intelligence

Introduction to Artificial Intelligence	• What is AI? • Examples of AI
Data Privacy	• Issues of privacy • Alternatives
Machine Bias	• Erroneous assumptions • Types of bias
Conclusion	• Defining success • Periodic evaluation

Video 3: Making Notes for an Essay

Purpose of Note-Taking

- Concretize the understanding of the text
- Get a complete understanding of the text
- Understand the flow of information in the text
- Revisit the text for future references
- Organize the text in our own words

Reading Precedes/Before Note-Taking

Types of reading

- Skimming
 - To understand the gist or the main ideas of the text
- Scanning
 - To look for specific information
- Both Skimming and Scanning are Primary reading techniques Which Helps decide whether to read a text or not
- Intensive reading
 - Comprehending, interpreting, and distinguishing between fact vs. opinion, argument, and evidence
 - Mapping the flow of information
- Critical reading
 - Evaluating the text and sources
 - Questioning the assumption and biases
 - Reading the text in relation to a larger context

How to Make Notes?

- Comprehend the text
- Identify the key points
- Identify the specific details
- Identify the structure of the text
- Identify the genre of the text
- Rewrite the point in your own words
- Based on the text, rewrite the text
 - Points
 - Flowcharts
 - Tree diagrams
- Organize the notes in a logical order
- Notes should reflect the structure of the text

Note-taking is not

- Writing points
- Including all the points
- Few diagrams
- Underlining
- Noting down

Video subtitles :

“ But how to make notes? First thing is to comprehend the text, you need to comprehend the text before you start making notes of the text. Then identify the key points, these are the key points as I said there are many things which could be written there but you are boiling

down to certain key points, which you will be your takeaway from that particular text. Identify the specific details of the text, which is again very important. Some specific way the text is engaging, and you are also looking for that kind of detail. Then identifying the structure of the text. This is somewhat also important, sometimes we say how the author of the text has a plan in his or her mind and he or she is structuring that essay in that way. You also need to identify that structure. Also sometimes it's helpful to identify the genre of the text, what kind of text it is, and depending on that you will be dealing with that. Because suppose an academic article is a different text and a journal article or a press article is a different text. An opinion piece published in a newspaper is a different text. You also need to identify sometimes what kind of text it is and then decide what kind of activity or usage it will have in your essay writing exercise. Then rewrite the points in your own words. This is something very important because plagiarism is a serious issue in academic writing and other kinds of writing. Even when you are referring to the ideas which have already been stated and argued, you cannot just simply write as it is like that. You need to write or rewrite the points in your own words, not using exactly what the author is using. Then finally based on a text, rewrite the text in form of points or flowcharts, or tree diagrams, or any other form which will be very helpful for you because you'd be referring this note when you will be writing your essay. You just keep them in a way which would help you to understand the structure, the way that ideas are mobilized, the way the ideas are functioning. That would be very helpful in your final exercise when you'll be writing your essay. Then organize the notes in a logical order, a very important point. You just also follow a logical order when you organize them, and the notes also somehow should reflect the structure of the text. Notes should be reflective of your entire reading exercises. These are some of the strategies which you can work on so that your note taking is very effective in the part when you use them, and your notes are really helpful for your final essay writing exercise. What is not note-taking? Simply writing points is not note-taking, including all the points is also not note-taking. Few diagrams are not note-taking, because they merely give you many sketchy ideas of the things you're writing. Not at all helpful as notes in your final exercise of essay writing, and underlining and noting down are also not note-taking."

Video 4: Strong Thesis Statement

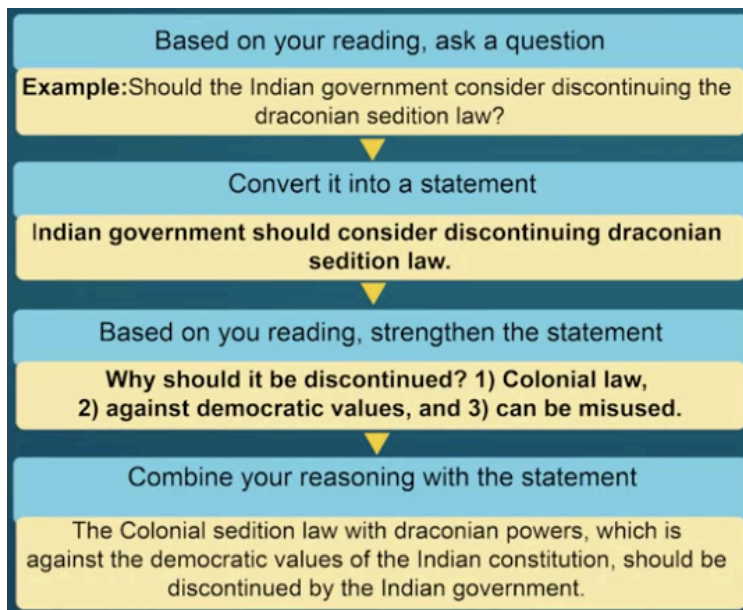
What Is the Thesis Statement?

- A formal statement/claim/generalization to be discussed in the essay
- Written in one or two sentences
- Usually found in an introductory paragraph
- Placed at the beginning or end of the introductory paragraph
- Must connect with the topic sentences in each paragraph of the essay

- Example:

Hydrogen-powered fuel cell electric cars are more efficient and greener than conventional gasoline-powered cars and electric cars using lithium batteries. (Claim)

Steps to Write a Thesis Statement



Writing a Strong Thesis Statement

- Clear
- Specific
- Not ambiguous
- Reflect the voice of the author
- Guide the reader
- Original opinion or idea, or claim
- Connect to other topic sentences in each paragraph of essay

Understanding the Structure of Short Essays

Video 1: Writing the Introductory Paragraph

Features of an Introductory Paragraph

- Starts with an opening statement
- The opening statement can be a general statement or thesis statement of the essay
- Provides context and background for the topic
- Introduces the purpose and aim of the essay
- Indicates the organization of the essay
- Defines the key terms important for the essay
- Mentions the limitation or what will not be covered in the essay

How to Write an Introduction?

- Start with a general sentence
- Draft a thesis statement in one or two sentences
- Expand the thesis statement or the argument
- Mention the scope of the study
- State the limitation of the study or topic
- Define the important terms or concepts
- Describe the order in which the ideas will be presented

Example of an Introductory Paragraph

It has been identified by many researchers that mansplaining is common among Indian men, and it is a prevalent communication pattern in Indian families. It is common because of the social biases associated with knowledge construction in India, for example, mostly male members of the family are consulted to discuss investment plans. This behaviour stems from the belief that men are more knowledgeable than women. Mansplain can be defined as 'substantiation of institutionalized sexism which contributes to the silencing and marginalization of women's voices' (Kidd, 2017, p.2). Researchers have studied mansplaining from multiple perspectives. The sociological perspective makes us understand how different institutions like family, politics, business, and workplace have institutionalized (Reels, 2012; Linda, 2014). The psychological perspective explains how this mental condition puts down women's confidence and causes fatigue (Kamble, 2008; Ajith, 2015). The discourse perspective enables us to understand how communication patterns and conventions are aiding the practice of mansplaining (Lux, 2018). This essay will discuss mansplaining from these three perspectives to understand the social conditioning of this societal phenomenon. In this essay, the economic perspective is not explored separately but is included under the sociological perspective.

Video subtitle:

"So at the beginning you have the thesis statement, we're talking about certain kinds of social practice, which is mansplaining for instance, in this case and then you are looking for a different kind of perspectives which is coming from a different kind of a discipline. You are also summarizing those key arguments, and then you are also at the beginning saying one perspective is particularly not explored separately because it's included under other kinds of perspective. So this is very clear and precise and the reader at the very beginning of your essay when he or she is reading an introductory paragraph is getting an idea. So this is your thesis statement, this is how we are going to argue, this is how the different components are organized and this is how the structure of the essay looks like. So that's how you can

develop and design and master your skill of writing introductory paragraphs, and that's what we discussed in this video."

Video 2: Writing the Concluding Paragraph

Features of a Conclusion Paragraph

- Starts with the summary of the main points
- Repeats the thesis statement or the main argument in different words
- Defines the findings or outcomes of the study
- Specifies the limitation or shortcoming of the study
- Mentions the implication of the topic or the study
- Can state the future possibilities

How to Write a Conclusion?

- Summarize all the main points again
- Reiterate the thesis statement once again
- Mention the implication of the study
- State the limitation of the study or topic
- Recommendation for the future study
- Can end the essay stating the possibility or solutions

Example of a Conclusion Paragraph

From the above discussion, it is clear that mansplaining is institutionalized and normalized in individual and group communication. Moreover, mansplaining is one of the techniques prevalently used by males to occupy public and private spaces. It can be observed that social and discursive factors play decisive in providing social sanction to this practice. In addition, the role of institutions in maintaining the practice through norms and communication is highlighted. To further understand the practice, it is important to study the operation of mansplaining in different social and economic settings. This could help in understanding this phenomenon in different classes and ethnic groups in India. Despite its limitation, this work has implications for individuals, companies, and institutions to practice gender-inclusive communication.

Video subtitle:

"If you just now read it carefully and observe the parts and the components, it connects the essay in a remaining part of the essay in a certain way because it starts with, "From the above discussion." It connects the ideas, but it summarizes them. It gives a key pointer kind of a thing for the reader because maybe they have been reading a lot of information, lot of ideas and opinions which are coming together so this is going to give him a quick gist of that. This is what we have been discussing so far. This is talking about the different part of the work, different components of the work, and also connecting them in a certain way, which is again, giving a clear picture of what the essay is about. It also includes the limitation, but it also says that despite the limitation, this has this kind of a potential or possibilities. These are the key points to keep in your mind when you plan or structure a concluding paragraph."

Video 3: Writing the Body Paragraph

Body Paragraph: Definition and Purpose

- Present an elaborate explanation of the main idea of an essay
- The argument of the topic is presented with supporting evidence and discussion
- Present evidence to a claim, so general information is followed by specific information

Components of Body Paragraphs

Topic sentence	• Appears at the beginning of a body paragraph • Captures the core idea of the body paragraph • Introduces the readers to that idea
Supporting sentences	• Present the arguments and provide evidence to support the claims • The evidence may include relevant literatures, empirical studies, laboratory experiments, or even personal experiences
Explanation	• Provide an extensive explanation • Present the analysis of the study in the essay
Conclusion	• Summarizes the discussion • Presents a new understanding on the main idea of the essay • Often a transition to the following section, the essay conclusion

Mapping Body Paragraphs

- Purpose of writing
 - It should be well outlined in the paragraphs
- Arguments and counterarguments
 - It might include counterarguments to strengthen the argument based on the claims made in the essay
- Paragraph breaks
 - Add clarity and comprehensibility to the discussion for more than one body paragraph in an essay.
- Revision
 - Proofreading, editing, and revision are essential factors that make any academic writing concise.

Video 4: Unity and Coherence in an Essay

Unity in an Essay

- It is important for writing an essay
- It retains the relevance of the discussion and makes an essay comprehensible
- An essay remains unified when the discussion follows the main idea that is mentioned in the topic sentence

Strategies to Maintain Unity in an Essay

- The essay should be developed around the main idea, which should be clearly stated in the topic sentence.
- The main idea should be supported with proper evidence/literature, and the arguments should be well explained.
- The discussion should have a logical flow and should stick to the main idea.
- The essay should be revised after eliminating irrelevant and redundant sentences.

Coherence in an Essay

- An essay becomes coherent when
 - The sentences follow a logical representation
 - The thoughts are not presented in an isolated manner

Strategies to Achieve Coherence in an Essay

- Following a logic in presenting the argument/topic
- Transitions can be used to connect the ideas from one sentence to the following one
 - Examples: moreover, next, nevertheless, certainly, in other words, finally, etc.
- Sentences can be ordered in a numerical sequence
 - This helps the readers to move from one point to the next.
- Paragraphs can be structured, maintaining a pattern of discussion
 - Example: from general discussion to specific, from question to answer, or from cause to effect, etc.

Video subtitle:

“ Now strategies to achieve coherence in an essay. So following a logic in presenting the argument and topics always helps. Then transition can be used to connect the ideas from one sentence to the following one. Examples you can use words like moreover, next, nevertheless, certainly, in other words, finally etc, and words like that. So it is connecting your thoughts. You are building up on a certain kind of an argument and you want to give more examples, more instances. You can say moreover and then sometimes you're saying certain kinds of things and the things which would strengthen your argument and then you said certainly or you were saying the same things but in a different way you can use words like, in other words. Or when you are summarizing certain kind of a thought process and you are adding one point to point, three point kind of thing and adding a final one, you can say that finally. So it would also be part of this process when you can make your essay really read as a kind of a coherent essay and sentences can be ordered in numerical sequences. This helps the readers to move from one point to the next point. Paragraph can be structured also maintaining a pattern of discussion, example from general discussion to specific. So first you start with a kind of a larger idea and then you specify what is your focus. What will be your focus in this particular essay or for question to answer. So for instance you start with a question and then the remaining paragraph built up on that question, it tries to answer. And then looking at different kind of nuances while answering to that question or from cause to effect. So this is also one kind of a logical kind of a structure that you can focus on. Now when you focus on in this coherence for essay and the kind of immunity of different kind of part of your essay.”

Signposting

- Signposting refers to the words and phrases that guide readers through an academic essay or dissertation.
- Signposting is divided into two types:
 - Major signposting
 - In introductions
 - This essay critically examines...
 - The aim of the present study is to...
 - The essay aims to critically examine/illustrate/investigate...
 - In body paragraphs
 - The current argument is based on an interesting viewpoint...
 - However, another perspective of this study suggests...
 - The evidence focuses on...
 - In conclusion
 - To summarize/to conclude..
 - The essay has highlighted four factors...
 - The argument that has been established in the present study..
 - Linking words and phrase
 - Again
 - Evidently
 - Furthermore
 - However
 - Obviously
 - Notably
 - Addition
 - Alternatively
 - Definitely

Video subtitle:

“So this is the thing to keep in your mind when you plan or structure or draft your academic essay or other kind of essays. How to maintain the unity and coherence. Something very, very important like quality of an essay in any given set up, any kind of requirement, you need to write in a certain way, which is coherent, so the reader is not misguided and not confused. It should be very clear and mastering certain skills of unity and coherence would actually help you to write essays which are more proper, which are academically more proper and also helpful for the reader to understand what is your concept, what is your research.”

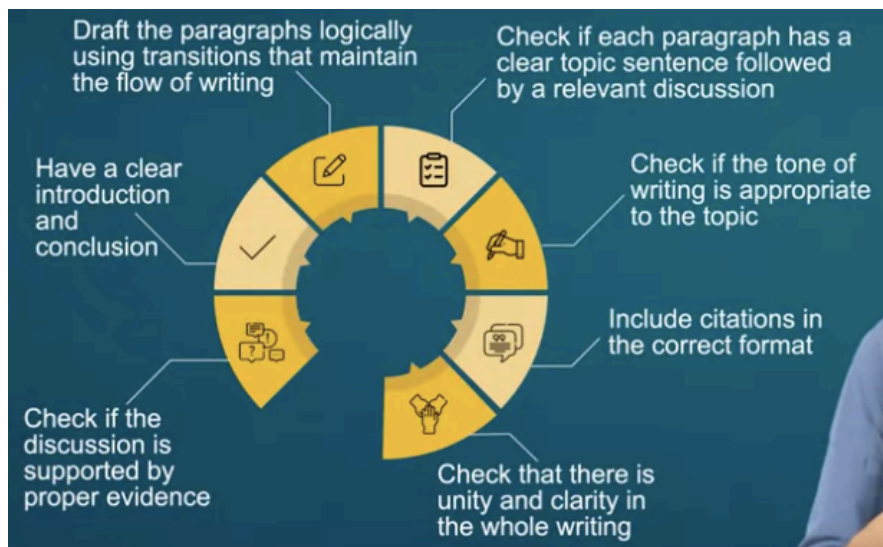
Editing, Proofreading, and Style Sheets

Video 1: Editing and Proofreading

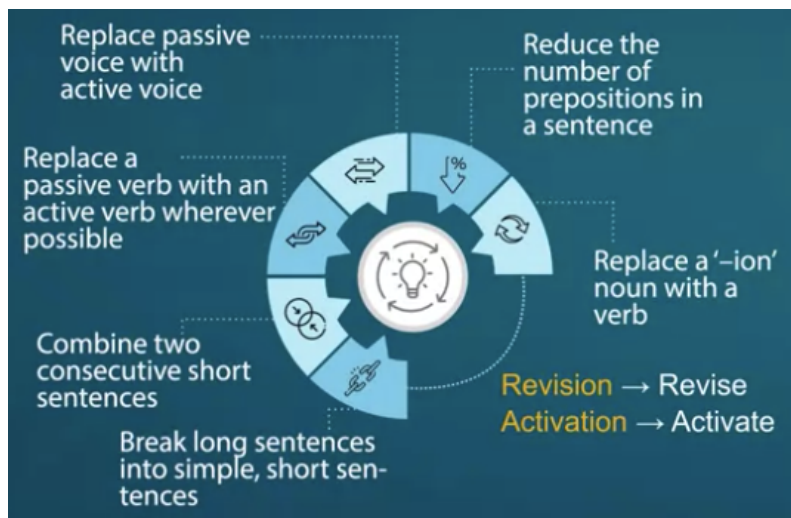
Editing and Proofreading in an Essay

- Editing an essay
 - Done while an essay/dissertation is being written
 - Starts from the first draft onward and continues throughout until the writing is submission ready
 - Adds clarity and precision to writing
- Proofreading of an essay
 - Happens toward the end of the writing process
 - Makes writing error-free
 - Grammatical errors, spelling mistakes, and typing errors are corrected during proofreading

Editing Techniques



Editing Strategies



Proofreading Strategies

- Take time to read the essay carefully and find out the errors
- Underline the places with errors
- Correct one type of error at a time
- Read the essay backward
- Read the essay aloud
- Focus on the correct use of punctuation

Video 2: Following Style Sheets in Writing

What Is a Style Sheet?

- Presents a set of rules
- Lists out specific elements and how they may be used in the writing
- Varies based on the type of publication and the field in which research is being conducted

Purpose of Using a Style Sheet

- Helps maintain consistency in academic writing
- Improves readability by providing more clarity
- Makes your writing appear more reliable and professional
- Provides a standard for : global audience
- Allows individuals to communicate and contribute to the existing field of knowledge cohesively
- Helps comply with the publishing standards and requirements of journals or other bodies
- Helps maintain the brand value and image

Style Guide Purview

- Punctuation
 - Various punctuations used in academic writing of a particular field of research are outlined with examples, and restrictions are mentioned.
- Spelling and acronyms
 - The use of spelling, acronyms, and short forms varies across different cultures, so standardization is attempted.
- Formatting
 - The type of fonts, size of text, use of images and figures, spacing, indentation, etc., are mentioned so that a standard is followed across articles
- Numbering
 - Rules for numbering sections, subsections, figures, lists, etc., are given.
- Reference
 - Rules for citing references of different kinds, such as journal articles, books, websites, etc., are given for both the reference list and in-text citation.

Video 3: Citations and Referencing

In-Text Citation

- How the writer mentions other articles or resources within the main text
- Below is an example of a definition cited from a book:

Horowitz and Sahni (1976) define an algorithm as "a finite set of instructions which, if followed, accomplish a particular task." We will use this rather simple definition to further explore data structures.

In-Text Citation: Commonly Used Formats

- Books or Journal Articles
 - (Author's Last name, year of publication)
 - Author's name (year of publication)
 - For example,
 - Brown (2014) presents contradictory thoughts in his article.
 - A series of models are discussed, and a contrastive analysis is carried out (Carrie, 2020).
- Website
 - (Organization name/group, year of publication)
 - Organization name/group (year of publication)
 - For example,
 - UNESCO (2020) commented on the digital divide and inequitable distribution of technology.

Reference List: Commonly Used Formats

- Book
 - Author's last name, first name initials. (year of publication). Title of book. Name of publisher. URL.
- Journal article
 - Author's last name, first name initials. (year of publication). Title of article. Journal name. Volume Number(Issue number), first-page number-last page number. URL.
- Website
 - Organization/company name. (year of publication, month/day if given). Title of the page. URL.
- Blog article
 - Author's last name, first name initials. [screen name if applicable]. (year of publication, month, and day of publication). Post title. Name of Blog. URL.

Video subtitle:

“ So when you talk about book in the reference list, where you mention the book, we start with the author's last name, first name initials. (publication). Then we write the title of the book, generally in italics. And then the name of publisher. And if possible the URL exists, then also you provide the URL. For journal article it goes in a similar manner, so you start with the author's last name, first name initials. Then you put a (year of publication). Then you provide the title of the article. Then journal name and again here journal name should be in italics. And then since the journal is very important for the writer to provide the volume number, issue numbers. So volume number you provide after the general name. And then in (issue number). Then you put a coma and then you mention the first page number to last page number. This is very important because you're talking about a full journal but you're only referring to one particular article, right. So you should provide the article page numbers and then again URL if it's possible to give. While talking about the website, you should name the organization or the company name at the very beginning. Then you put a bracket, you mention the year of publication again followed by a comma and then a month, day. If it's possible if it's given in the source resources, you should also put that then you close your bracket. Then you write the name of the title of the page in italics and then you put a full stop and provide the URL website. So you have to provide the URL because it is the access you also used during your research or your essay writing. In case of the blog articles, you write the author's last name first, then put coma then put the first name initials. Then you put a third bracket and then write the screen name if applicable then close your bracket. Then (year of publication), and a month and the year of publication), and then post title, name of the blog, again the name of the blog should be in italics. And then finally you provide the URL. Again for a blog article, you're accessing it through a URL, right, so you have to provide the URL here. So it's not a kind of an optional thing. You have to provide the URL.”